

DAY 2: EMAIL HARVESTING & SOCIAL ENGINEERING PREP

Internship Program: Sqrock IT Solutions – Cybersecurity Internship (Phase 1)

- **Intern Name:** Kaif Dhukka
- **Target URL:** https://httpbin.org
- **Execution Date:** August 25, 2026

1. Task Objective

To ethically harvest publicly available email addresses from a web target using regular expressions (Regex) in Python and understand how attackers utilize harvested emails for social engineering.

2. Key Concepts & Theory

- **Email Harvesting:** The practice of scraping publicly exposed email addresses from websites, forums, or WHOIS data using automated scripts or regex.
- **Pretexting:** Creating a fabricated scenario (pretext) to manipulate a target into divulging sensitive information or performing actions they wouldn't normally do.
- **Regex Scraping:** Utilizing regex patterns (such as `[\w.+-]+\@[\w-]+\.[a-zA-Z]{2,}`) to match and extract email signatures automatically from raw HTML source code.

3. How Attackers Use Harvested Emails

- **Spear Phishing:** Extracted emails are targeted with personalized malicious messages pretending to be internal IT, HR, or financial departments.
- **Credential Stuffing & Password Spraying:** Attackers use discovered emails as usernames against corporate portals (VPN, O365) testing weak or common passwords.

4. Proof of Execution (Output)

```
PS C:\Users\LAPPY\OneDrive\Documents\Sqrock_Cybersecurity_Internship\Day_02_Email_Harvesting>
PS C:\Users\LAPPY\OneDrive\Documents\Sqrock_Cybersecurity_Internship\Day_02_Email_Harvesting> python email_harvester.py
[*] Email Harvesting Results for https://httpbin.org:

[+] Found: me@kennethreitz.org
PS C:\Users\LAPPY\OneDrive\Documents\Sqrock_Cybersecurity_Internship\Day_02_Email_Harvesting>
```